

4:31. *καὶ πρὸς τούτοις*. Probably for *וְעַם דִּנְהָ*, which should here have been translated "and in spite of this."

4:37. *καὶ οὐκ ἔστιν* should probably be *εἰ οὐκ ἔστιν*. The original may well have been *וְלֹא אִתִּי בְּהֶן קוֹשָׁטָא*; all men and all their works are evil, "if truth be not in them;" or the initial letter of *הֶן*, "if," may have fallen out accidentally after the last letter of the preceding word (*τοιαῦτα* = *דְּנָה* or *אֱלֶה*).

4:39. *τὰ δίκαια ποιεῖ ἀπὸ πάντων τῶν ἀδίκων καὶ πονηρῶν*. The *ἀπὸ* is a monstrosity here; see the commentaries. The Lagarde text, *δίκαια ποιεῖ, καὶ ἀπὸ πάντων τῶν ἀδίκων καὶ πονηρῶν ἀπέχεται*, is arbitrarily corrected, as the evidence of manuscripts and versions shows conclusively. Fritzsche thinks it likely that some Hebrew idiom "schwebte dem Verfasser vor," but confesses his inability to find an example of it in our Hebrew Bible. We have precisely this idiom in biblical Aramaic, in Ezra 7:26. The original text here was therefore undoubtedly *לְהֶן דִּינָא עֲבַד מִן כְּלָהֶן בִּישָׁא וְרִשְׁיָא*; Truth is no respecter of persons, "but executes judgment upon all evil and wicked men." The Latin and Syriac versions render correctly.

These examples will suffice. The Story of the Three Youths was written in Aramaic, and was inserted by a redactor in the Hebrew-Aramaic text of the Chronicler's history.

The process of combining the two narratives necessarily involved some harmonistic labors on the part of the redactor. The Story, in its original form, does not seem to have made any mention of the Jews. As far as 4:42—where it may well have ended—it contains not a word to give it connection with Jewish history or interests, with the exception of the single parenthetical clause in vs. 11, *οὗτός ἐστιν Ζοροβαβέλ* (*הוּא זְרַבבֶּל*), which has been universally recognized as an addition by a later hand. It may well be that this very brief, but very potent, gloss antedates the expanded form of the Story, and in fact was the ultimate cause of its inclusion in a history of the Jewish people; but, be that as it may, it is pretty certain that the expansion itself, through which the Story was made into a tale of exiles returning to Jerusalem by royal decree, was the work of the self-same redactor who interpolated it in the Chronicler's book.

Now it must be remembered that the Chronicler himself is giving, at this very point, an account of a return of exiles from Babylonia; and, what is more, that the leaders of his expedition